The Geek Wants Out

By Ernest Cline

(Pgs 14-17) At first glance

I probably appear to be a somewhat ordinary,

somewhat average-looking fellow.

Calm, harmless, at ease.

But this is by design.

You see, it is through decades of research and rigorous

training that I have crafted this façade of normalcy.

And now, through intense concentration,

I am able to function in a social setting.

I can speak at length with educated people about

pertinent matters of public importance,

such as literature,

or the current political climate in Europe.

I am capable of conversing with you

without ever revealing that just underneath the surface

of this manufactured veneer

there hides an altogether different person.

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A monster, some might say.

My alter-ego.

INTRODUCTION

There's never been a better time in history if you're a geek. Comic books are getting serious big-budget movie adaptations. Captain America Rocks! Video games are getting more realistic and more compelling all the time. Buh, bye, Mario Cart! And Pop culture conventions (basically huge events where geeks can congregate) are popping up all over the country, giving geeks huge events where they can congregate. Comic-Con Rocks!

Now, I know I'm not likely to turn my love for Ghostbusters or Power Rangers into a lucrative career. But geeks ***are*** *inheriting the Earth (whispers "Elon Musk").*

By golly, if Elon and Ernest Cline, a regular dude who used to work in IT and did slam poetry, found a way to do it, I can, too! I'm not hiding my true geek nature anymore!

The Geek Wants Out by Earnest Cline

[My alter-ego] is the opposite of the image I project.

He is the antithesis of Cool.

He is the last person you want to get trapped in a conversation with.

He is The Geek.

The obsessive science fiction movie watching,

comic book collecting,

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Monty Python dialogue memorizing,
("Your mother was a hamster and your father smelt of elderberries!" – Monty Python and the Holy Grail)
Dungeons and Dragons playing GEEK
that I struggle daily to keep hidden from the world.

But The Geek Wants Out.
He wants to talk to you.
He wants to give you his doctoral dissertation on why
The Adventures of Buckaroo Banzai Across the 8th Dimension
is the greatest film of all time!
("Hey, now. Don't be mean; we don't have to be mean, cause, remember, no matter where you go, there you are.")

He wants to slap you because
you've never seen *Big Trouble in Little China.*
What? Have you been living in a cave?!

He wants to kick you're a** in Star Wars Trivial Pursuit.
And he will.
Because he's a Geek.
*(**Question:** The young Jedi Knight, Anakin Skywalker, becomes who in Star Wars? **Answer:** Darth Vader! -- (in a Darth Vader voice: "Luke, I am your father")*

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And he wants his toys.
He wants the complete set
in mint condition,
still in the box.

He wants every item on the planet
that is even remotely related to Ultraman.
Because Ultraman is Airwolf!

He could give a squirt
about sports or politics or rhetoric.
Such things are of no consequence to him.
What matters is the release date of the
next *Lord of the Rings* movie!
("One ring to rule them all, one ring to find them, one ring to bring them all and in the darkness bind them." — Gandalf)

(From When I was a Kid, Pg 11-12)

[It wasn't that long ago when] we didn't have any fancy Sony
PlayStation video games
with high-resolution 3D graphics.
(scoffs) Atari 2600
with games like Space Invaders and Asteroids. *(scoffs)*
and the graphics sucked!
Your guy was just a square!

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You had to use your imagination!
And there were no multiple levels or screens,.
It was just one screen, forever,
and you could never win.

The game just kept getting harder and faster until you died. Just like life! *(deep breath after this diatribe)*

You see, The Geek can't wait.
The Geek has no patience.
He wants what he wants when he wants it.
And all he wants is stupid *stuff*!

He wants his own TARDIS.
He wants his own light saber.
He wants to buy a DeLorean
And he wants to drive it 88 miles per hour.

He wants movies.
He wants to see the Director's Cut.
He wants the impossible-to-find Japanese bootleg with
6 minutes of never-before-seen footage.

He wants to watch *Blade Runner*. Again.
He wants to watch *Brazil*. Again.
He wants to watch *A Clockwork Orange.*
Again and Again!

But I deprive him of these things, as best I can,
until I can no longer ignore his voice
screaming in my head.

I am Jekyll. He is Hyde.
I am Bruce Banner. He is the Hulk.
Especially the Hulk from issues #272 to #378.

But no longer!
I am putting a stop to all this nerdy s*** right now!
I'm an adult, for Christ's sake!
And this body isn't big enough for the both of us.
One of us has to go, and it's gonna be him.
I banishing the Geek forever to the Phantom Zone,
just like in *Superman II* !
Because, in the end –
there can be only one.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Ernest Cline
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AWARD HISTORY

2004 National Qualifier
2008 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
2010 National Qualifier
(Combined with Urges by Poetri)
2021 National Qualifier – MS
2023 National Qualifier – MS
IN State Qualifier
KS State Qualifier

NOTE: Quotes from Movies and Trivia are not included in the original poem.

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